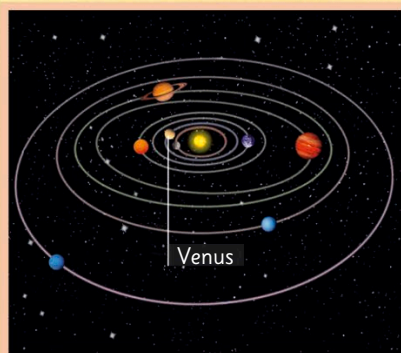




From the Earth, Venus is easiest to see when it appears to be farthest in the sky from the Sun.

The morning star

You wouldn't want to visit Venus. You'd be crushed in an instant and your remains fried to a crisp. This barren planet is covered in acid clouds, and it has an incredibly dense atmosphere.

Where is it?

Venus is the brightest planet. It can be seen in the early morning or early evening sky, depending on where it is in its orbit around the Sun. That's why it's known as the morning or evening star.



Venus's rocky plains without cloud cover

A mass of clouds

The cloud layer is too thick to let much sunlight penetrate, but it does reflect a lot of light. In fact, after the Moon, Venus is the brightest object in our night sky.



Caused by chemicals in the atmosphere, the dark cloud tops (shown exaggerated in this image) blow around the planet.